MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Engineering | CI/CD and Test Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including hands-on work improving CI/CD pipelines and building test infrastructure. Experienced in GitLab CI, Docker, Helm deployments to a shared Kubernetes cluster, and monitoring test reliability. Personal infrastructure projects include a k3s homelab managed with Argo CD and a Hetzner VPS provisioned with Terraform. Seeking to move into a DevOps / platform engineering role.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for 3 product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage; monthly CI runner cost fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge request test environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster; environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, and are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 2%.
- Built a Python-based test results pipeline and Grafana dashboards to help teams identify flaky tests.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test data seeding and an internal guide to CI used in onboarding.
- Mentored 2 QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECT

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal project | 2024–2025

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from a Git repository through Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, plus Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

SKILLS

CI/CD and Containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose
Infrastructure and Platforms: Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access and deployments to a shared cluster), k3s, Terraform, Argo CD, Ansible (basic)
Monitoring and Data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, SQL
Scripting and Testing: Python, Bash, pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman, Java (test code)
Systems: Linux, Git
Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics through personal learning

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) | Studying; exam booked for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)